

1. Lab Overview

In this lab, I practiced **Active Directory user account management** in a Windows Server 2019 domain environment. The lab focused on creating user accounts, adding users to groups, updating user properties, signing in with a domain account, resetting passwords, disabling and enabling accounts, moving users, renaming users, deleting users, and searching Active Directory.

This lab builds on Lab 04 and Lab 05, where I created the [wara.edu](#) domain and organized Active Directory using OUs and groups.

2. Business Scenario

This lab simulates a real IT support environment where help desk analysts and junior system administrators manage user accounts in Active Directory.

As the system administrator, I created users for staff and students, assigned group membership, updated user information, tested domain sign-ins, reset passwords, disabled and enabled accounts, and searched for directory objects.

These are common support tasks in business environments where IT teams handle onboarding, account access, password resets, user updates, and account lifecycle management.

3. Lab Objectives

The objectives of this lab were to:

- Create new Active Directory user accounts.
- Add user accounts to group accounts.
- Manage user account properties.
- Sign in to the domain with a new user account.
- Disable user accounts.
- Reset user passwords.
- Move user accounts between OUs.
- Rename user accounts.
- Delete user accounts.
- Query/search Active Directory objects.

4. Lab Environment

Item	Details
Server VM	Windows Server 2019
Client VM	Windows 10
Domain	wara.edu
Main Tool	Active Directory Users and Computers
User Types	Admin user and non-admin user
Example Groups	Domain Admins, Honors Students
Main Skills	User creation, group membership, password reset, account disable/enable, AD search

5. Tools Used

- Windows Server 2019
- Windows 10
- Active Directory Users and Computers
- PowerShell
- Domain sign-in screen
- Find tool in Active Directory
- User account properties
- Group membership settings

6. Steps Performed

Step 1: Created a New User Account

I opened **Active Directory Users and Computers** and created a new user account inside the **Staff OU**.

During the user creation process, I entered the user's first name, initials, last name, full name, and user logon name. Then I created a complex password and completed the account setup.

The lab section explains how to create a new user object in Active Directory and configure the user's name, logon name, and password.

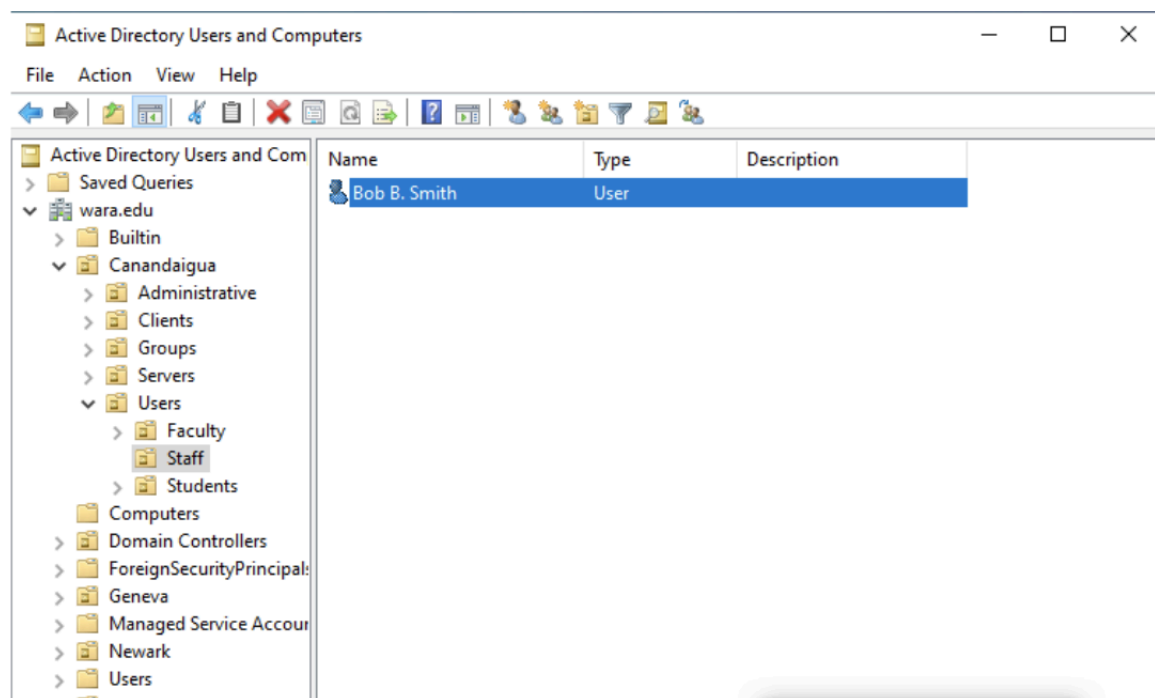
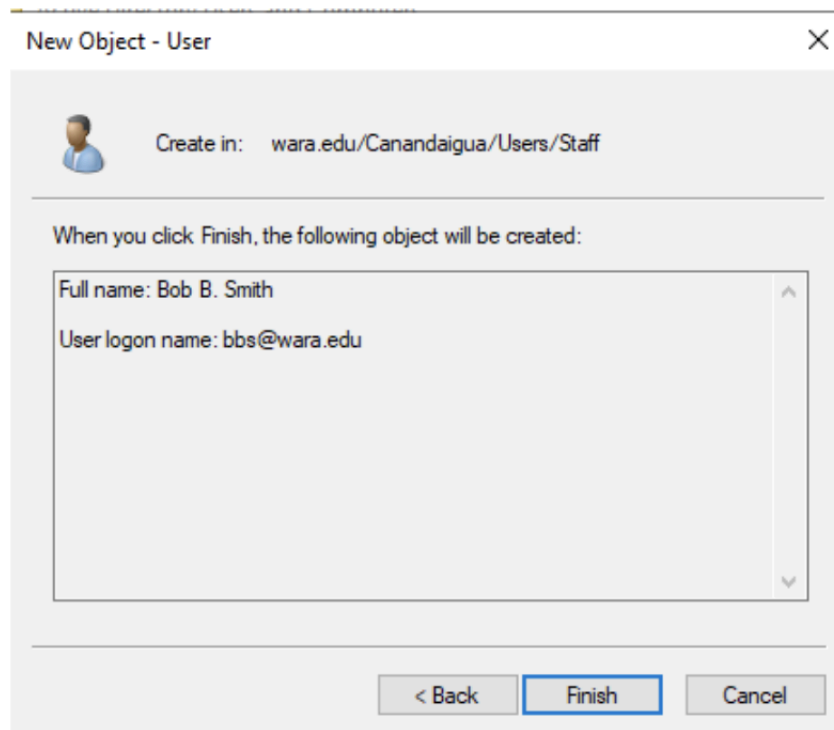


Figure 1: New Active Directory user account created inside the Staff OU.

Step 2: Created a Non-Admin User Account

Next, I created a second user account without administrative privileges. This account was used to test standard domain user access.

For this user, I left **User must change password at next logon** selected. This allowed me to practice a common IT support task where a temporary password is assigned and the user is required to change it at first sign-in.

The lab explains that this setting ensures the user is prompted to change the default password during the first login.

New Object - User

Create in: wara.edu/Canandaigua/Users/Students

When you click Finish, the following object will be created:

Full name: Alice I. Wonderland
User logon name: aiw@wara.edu

< Back Finish Cancel

Alice I. Wonderland Properties

Member Of	Dial-in	Environment	Sessions
Remote control	Remote Desktop Services Profile		COM+
General	Address	Account	Profile
	Telephones	Organization	

User logon name:
aiw @wara.edu

User logon name (pre-Windows 2000):
WARA\ aiw

Logon Hours... Log On To...

☐ Unlock account

Account options:

- ☒ User must change password at next logon
- ☐ User cannot change password
- ☐ Password never expires
- ☐ Store password using reversible encryption

Account expires

☒ Never

☐ End of: Wednesday, March 27, 2024

OK Cancel Apply Help

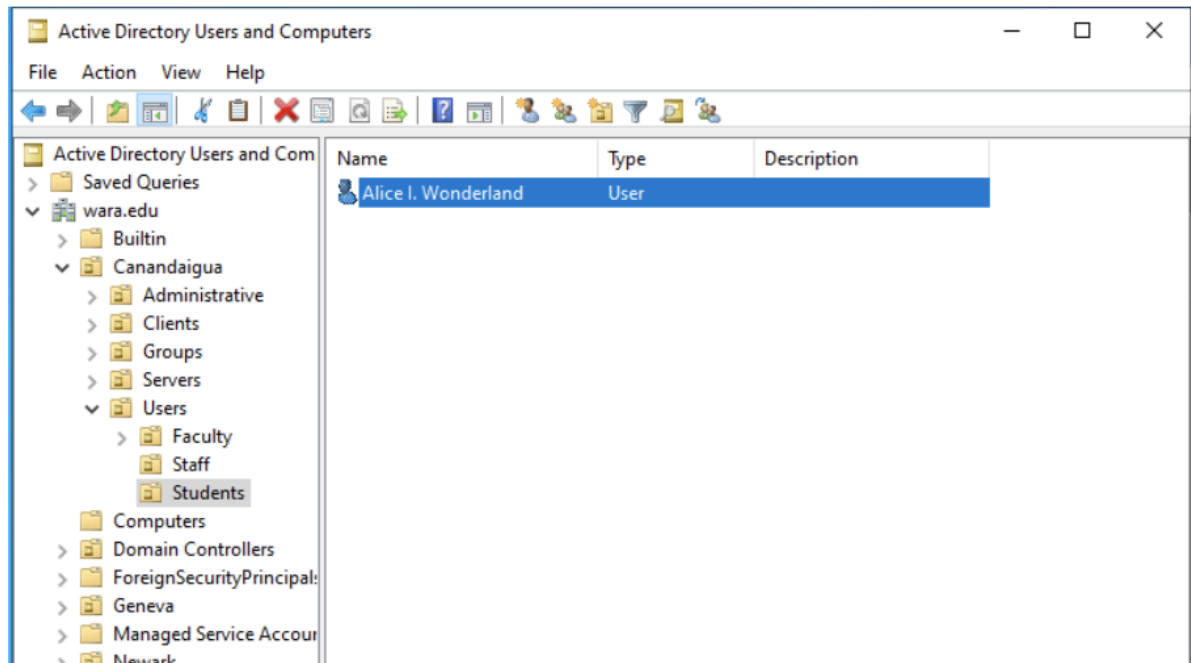


Figure 2: Non-admin domain user account created with password change required at next login.

Step 3: Added Users to Groups

I practiced assigning users to Active Directory groups.

First, I added the admin user to the **Domain Admins** group, which gave that account administrative privileges in the domain. Then I added the non-admin user to the **Honors Students** group.

This helped me understand how group membership controls access and privilege levels in Active Directory.

The lab explains that the first user was added to the Domain Admins group and the non-admin user was added to the Honors Students group.



- Active Directory Users and Computers
- Saved Queries
 - wara.edu
 - Builtin
 - Canandaigua
 - Administrative
 - Clients
 - Groups
 - Servers
 - Users
 - Faculty
 - Staff
 - Students
 - Computers
 - Domain Controllers
 - ForeignSecurityPrincipals
 - Geneva
 - Managed Service Accounts
 - Newark
 - Users
 - Victor

Name	Type	Description
Access Control Assistance Operators	Security Group...	Members of this group ...
Account Operators	Security Group...	Members can administe...
Administrators	Security Group...	Administrators have co...

Administrators Properties

General Members Member Of Managed By



Administrators

Group name (pre-Windows 2000):

Administrators

Description:

Administrators have complete and unrestricted access to

E-mail:

Group scope

- ☒ Builtin local
☐ Global
☐ Universal

Group type

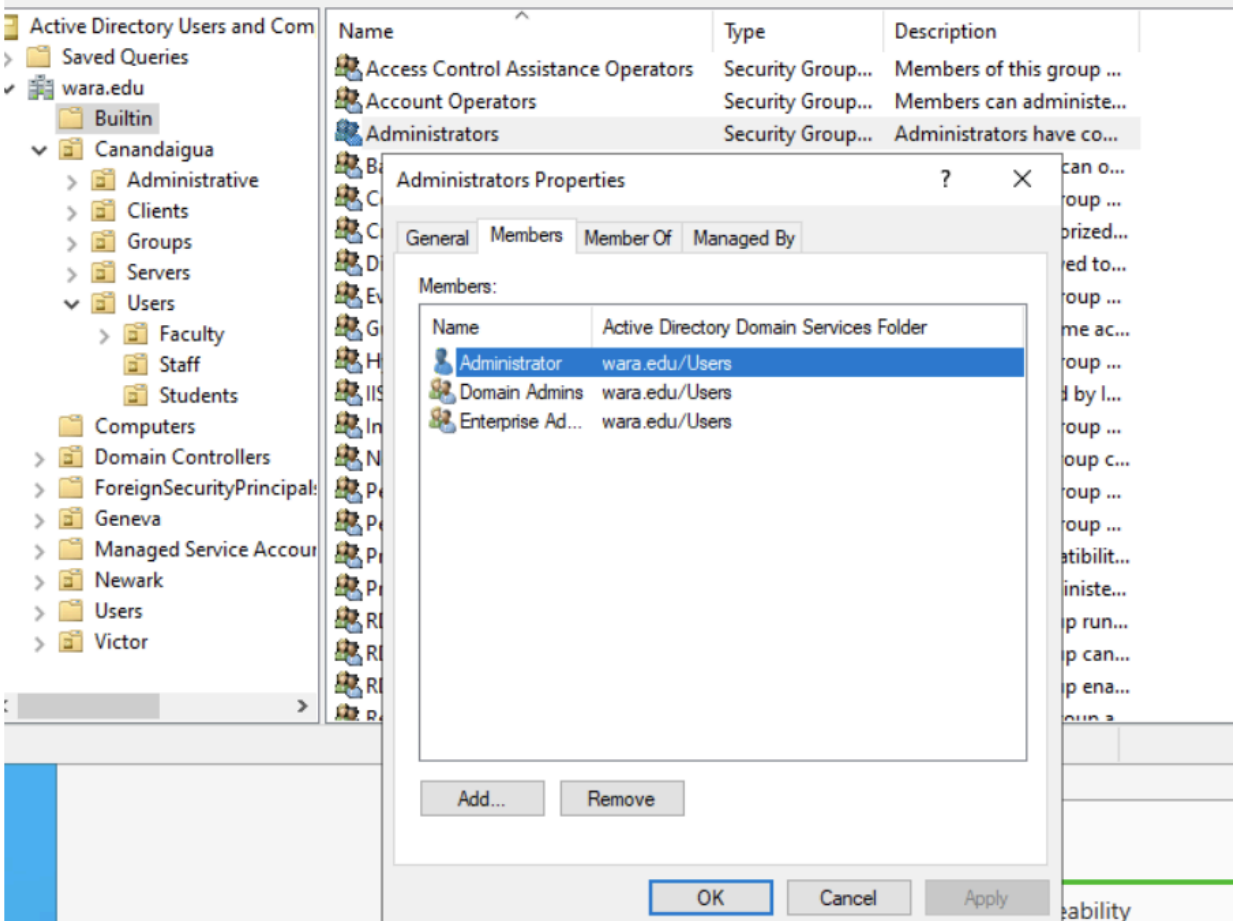
- ☒ Security
☐ Distribution

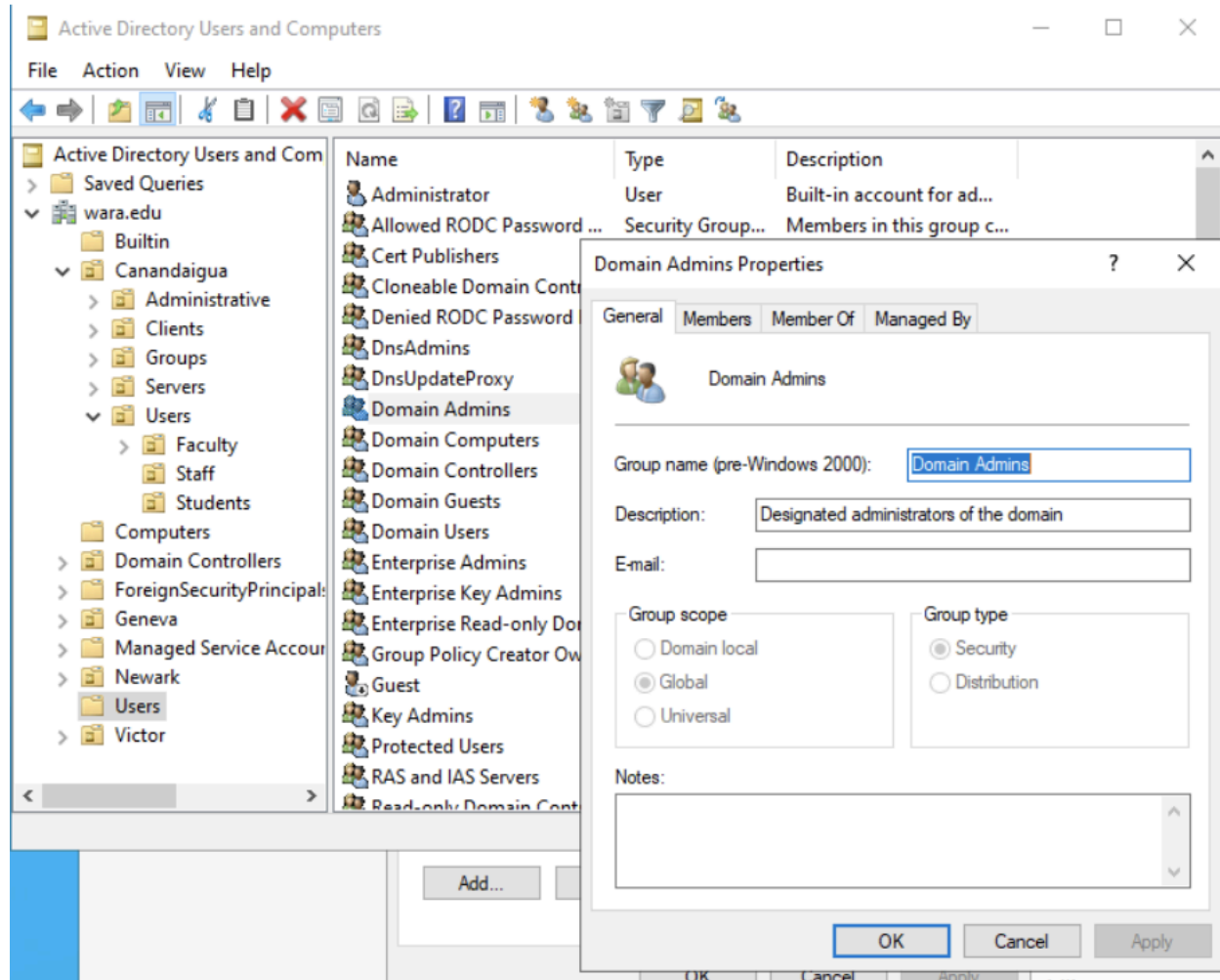
Notes:

OK

Cancel

Apply





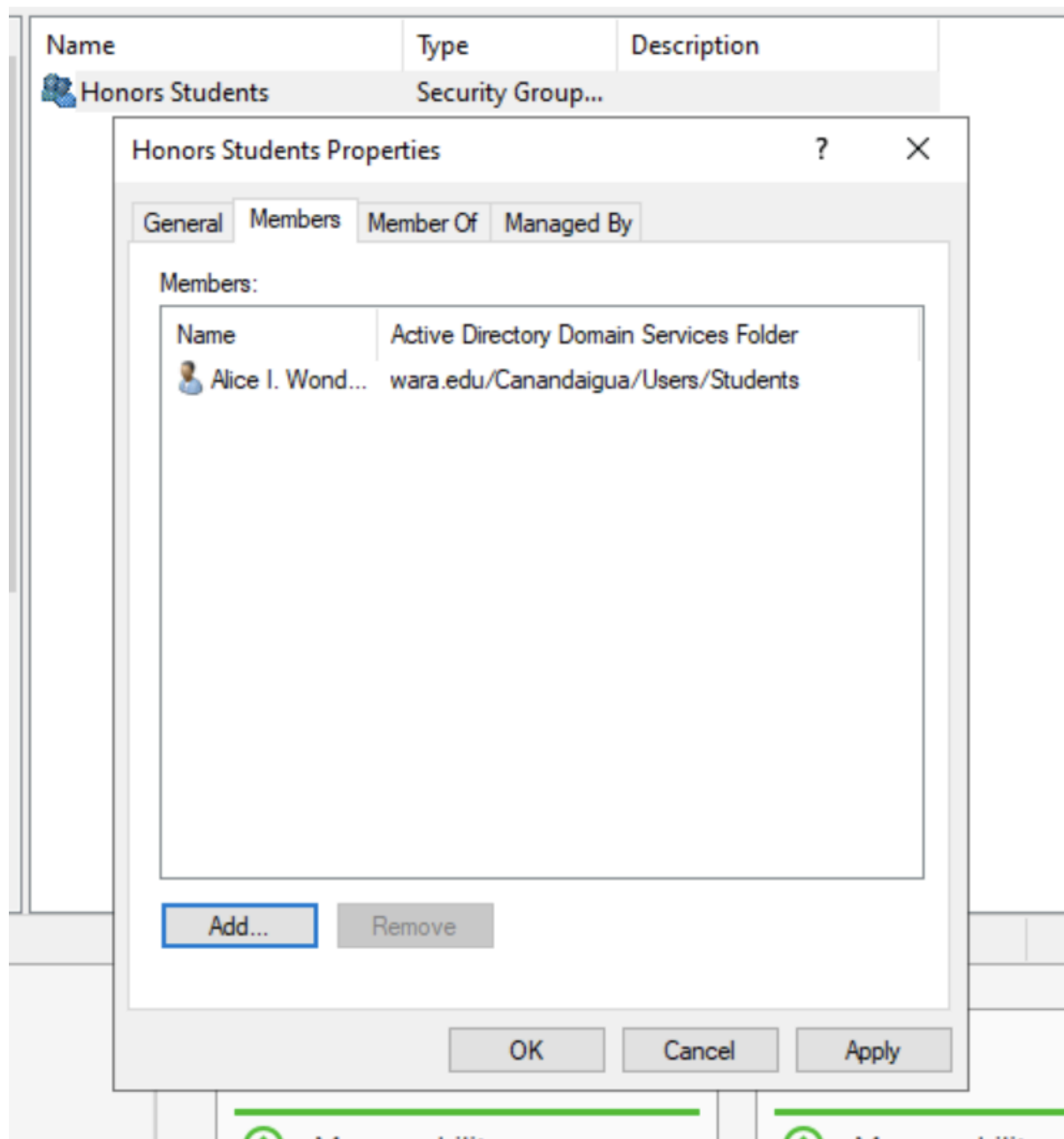


Figure 3: User account added to the appropriate Active Directory security group.

Step 4: Updated User Account Properties

I updated the properties of the non-admin user account in Active Directory.

This included editing fields such as:

Description
Office
Telephone number
Email address
Web page
Street address
City
State
Zip code
Country/Region

This is useful in real environments because Active Directory often stores employee contact and organizational information.

The lab shows how to update user object properties using the General and Address tabs.

Active Directory Users and Computers

File Action View Help

Navigation pane showing the hierarchy of Active Directory objects:

- > Clients
 - > Groups
 - > Business Services
 - > Facilities and Services
 - > Faculty
 - > Finance
 - > Human Resources
 - > Information Technology
 - > Marketing
 - > One Stop Center
 - > Research and Innovation
 - > Staff
 - > Students
 - > Servers
 - > Users
 - > Faculty
 - > Staff
 - > Students
- > Computers
- > Domain Controllers
- > ForeignSecurityPrincipals
- > Geneva

Name	Type
Alice I. Wonderland	User

Alice I. Wonderland Properties

Member Of	Dial-in	Environment	Sessions
Remote control	Remote Desktop Services Profile	COM+	

General Address Account Profile Telephones Organization

 Alice I. Wonderland

First name: Initials:

Last name:

Display name:

Description:

Office:

Telephone number:

E-mail:

Web page:

Alice I. Wonderland Properties

Member Of	Dial-in	Environment	Sessions
Remote control	Remote Desktop Services Profile		COM+
General	Address	Account	Profile
		Telephones	Organization

Street: 123 Main street

P.O. Box: 190

City: Canandaigua

State/province: NY

Zip/Postal Code: 14424

Country/region: United States

OK Cancel Apply Help

Figure 4: User account properties updated in Active Directory.

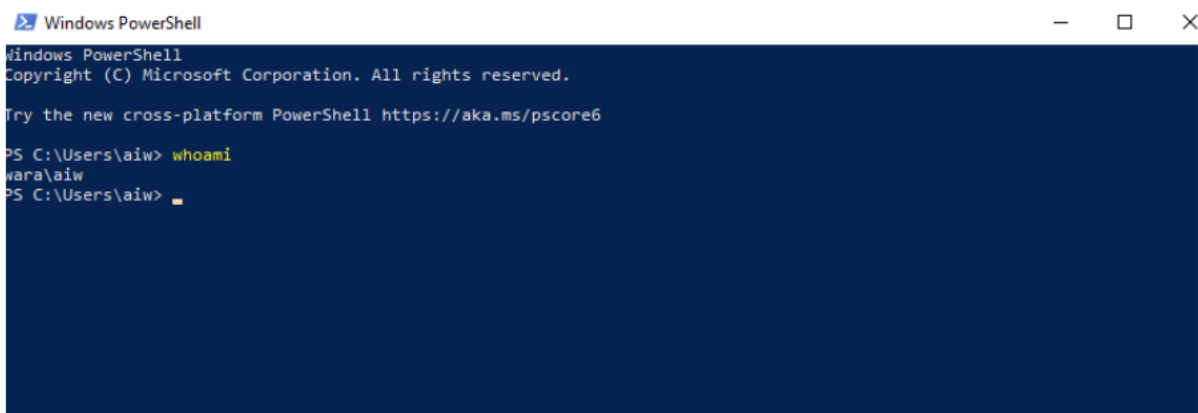
Step 5: Signed in with a Domain User Account

After creating the non-admin user account, I signed in to the Windows 10 client using the new domain account.

Because **User must change password at next logon** was enabled, the user was prompted to change the temporary password during the first sign-in.

After signing in, I used PowerShell and the `whoami` command to verify the domain user identity.

The lab explains that the `whoami` command displays the domain followed by the username.

A screenshot of a Windows PowerShell window. The title bar reads "Windows PowerShell". The window content shows the following text: "Windows PowerShell", "Copyright (C) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.", "Try the new cross-platform PowerShell https://aka.ms/pscore6", "PS C:\Users\aiw> whoami", "wara\aiw", and "PS C:\Users\aiw>". The command prompt is currently at the end of the last line.

```
Windows PowerShell
Copyright (C) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

Try the new cross-platform PowerShell https://aka.ms/pscore6

PS C:\Users\aiw> whoami
wara\aiw
PS C:\Users\aiw>
```

Figure 5: Domain user successfully signed in and verified using `whoami`.

Step 6: Reset the Password for a Non-Admin User

I practiced resetting a password for the non-admin user account.

In Active Directory Users and Computers, I located the user account, selected Reset Password, entered a new temporary password, and left User must change password at next logon enabled.

Then I tested the password reset by signing in from the Windows 10 client and changing the password when prompted.

This is one of the most common IT support tasks.

The lab explains how to reset a non-admin user's password and require the user to change it at next logon.

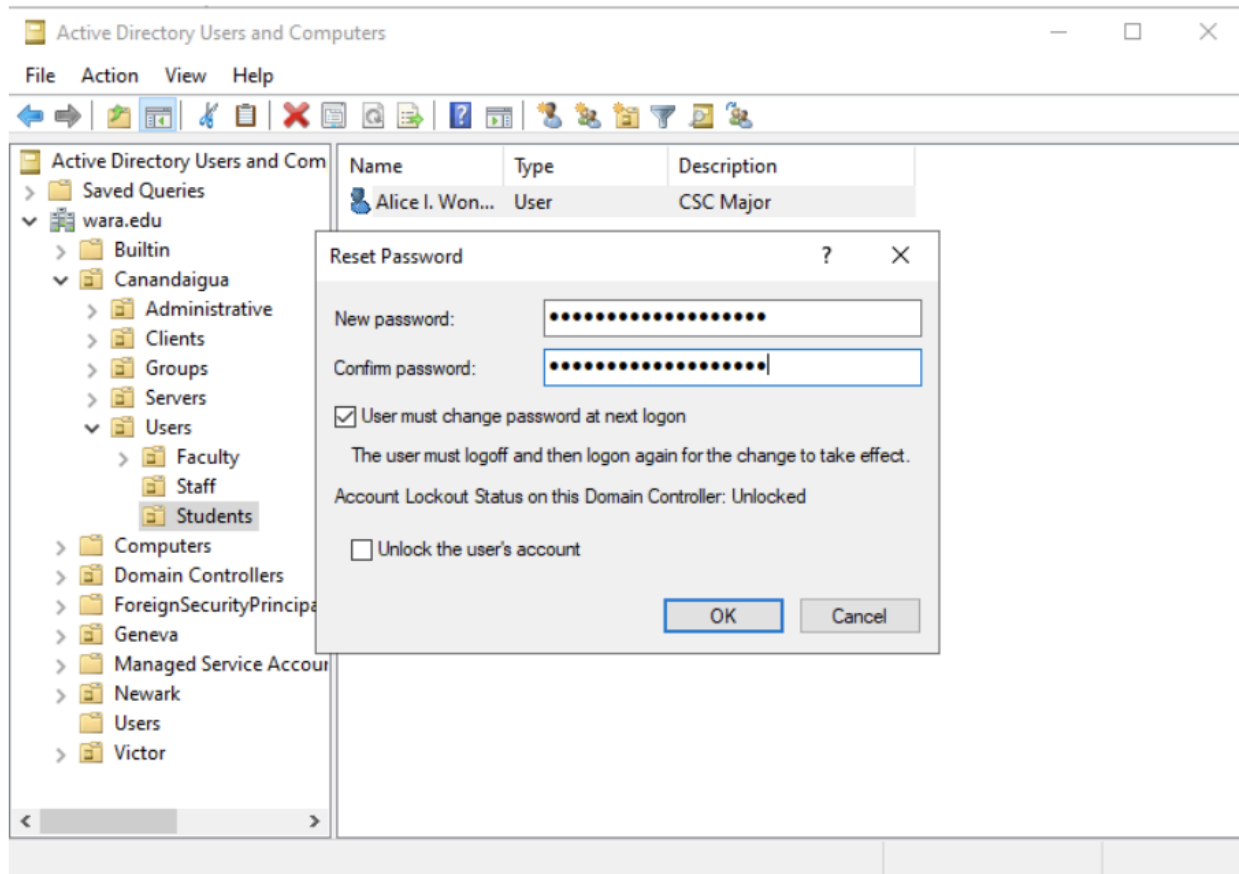


Figure 6: Password reset completed for a non-admin domain user account.

Step 7: Disabled and Enabled a User Account

I practiced disabling and enabling an Active Directory user account.

First, I disabled the non-admin user account in Active Directory Users and Computers. Then I attempted to sign in from the Windows 10 client, but the disabled account could not log in.

After testing the disabled account, I enabled the account again and verified that the user could sign in successfully.

The lab explains that disabled accounts cannot sign in until they are enabled again.



Other user

Your account has been disabled. Please see your system administrator.

OK

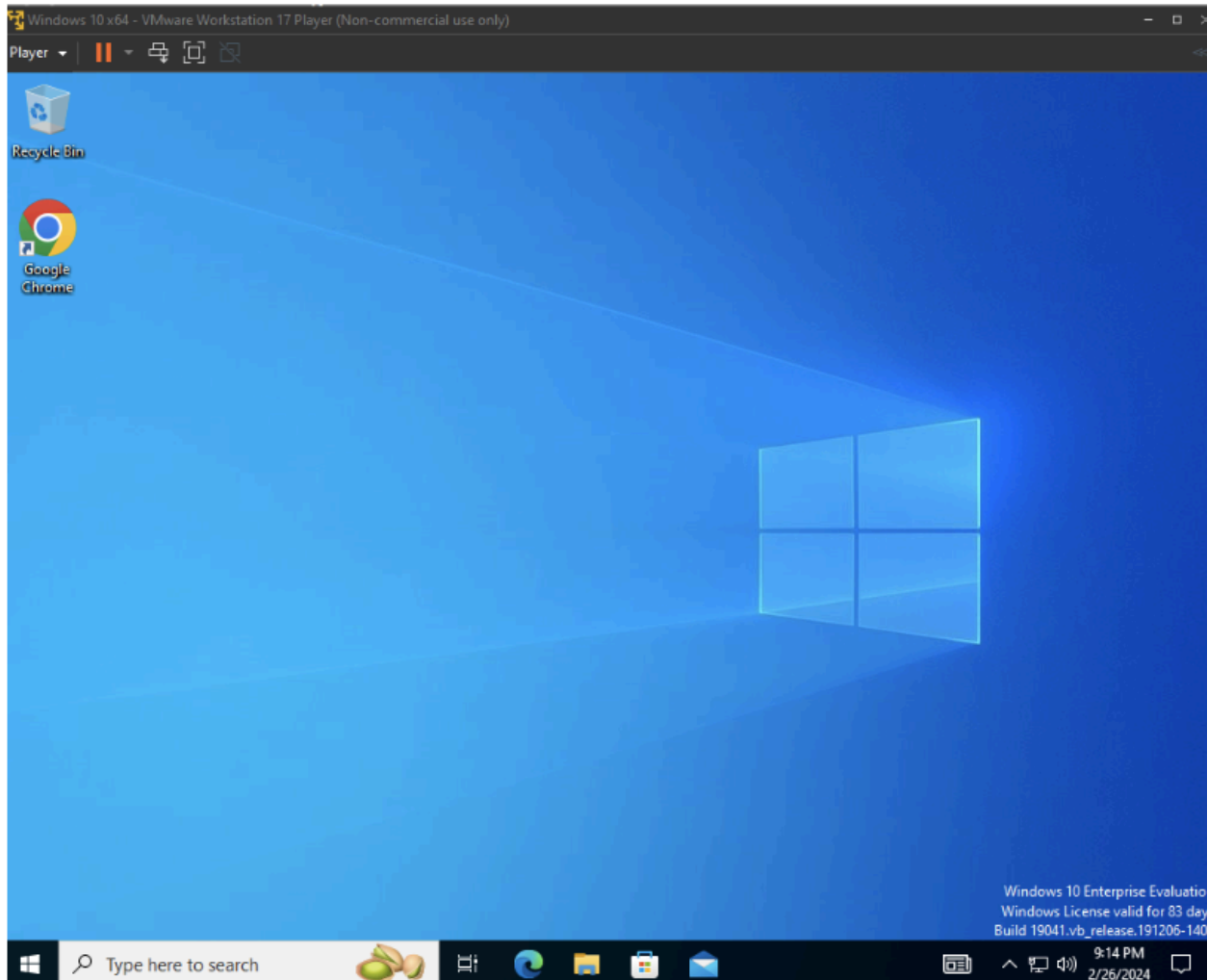


Figure 7: User account disabled and re-enabled to test account access control.

Step 8: Moved, Renamed, and Deleted User Accounts

I practiced managing the user account lifecycle by moving, renaming, and deleting user accounts.

The tasks included:

- Moving the non-admin user from the Students OU to the Staff OU.
- Moving the user back to the Students OU.
- Updating user properties.
- Renaming the user account.
- Creating a test user account.
- Deleting the test user account.

The lab also noted that deleting accounts is irreversible and that disabling accounts is often preferred for forensic or recordkeeping purposes.

Active Directory Users and Computers

FileActionViewHelp

←→



Active Directory Users and Com

> Saved Queries

▼ wara.edu

> Builtin

▼ Canandaigua

> Administrative

> Clients

> Groups

> Servers

▼ Users

> Faculty

Staff

Students

> Computers

> Domain Controllers

> ForeignSecurityPrincipal:

> Geneva

> Managed Service Accour

> Newark

Users

> Victor

Name	Type	Description
Bob B. Smith	User	
Alice I. Won...	User	CSC Major

<

>

Active Directory Users and Computers

FileActionViewHelp

Active Directory Users and Computers

Saved Queries

wara.edu

Builtin

Canandaigua

Administrative

Clients

Groups

Servers

Users

Faculty

Staff

Students

Computers

Domain Controllers

ForeignSecurityPrincipal...

Geneva

Managed Service Account...

Newark

Users

Victor

Name	Type	Description
Alice I. Won...	User	CSC Major

Alice I. Wonderland Properties



Member Of	Dial-in	Environment	Sessions
Remote control	Remote Desktop Services Profile		COM+
General	Address	Account	Profile
	Telephones	Organization	



Alice I. Wonderland

First name: Initials:

Last name:

Display name:

Description:

Office:

Telephone number:

E-mail:

Web page:

OK

Cancel

Apply

Help

	Name	Type	Description
--	------	------	-------------

Rename User?×

Full name:

Alice I. Johnson

First name:

Alice

Last name:

Johnson

Display name:

Alice I. Johnson

User logon name:

a ij

@wara.edu

User logon name (pre-Windows 2000):

WARA\

a ij

OK

Cancel

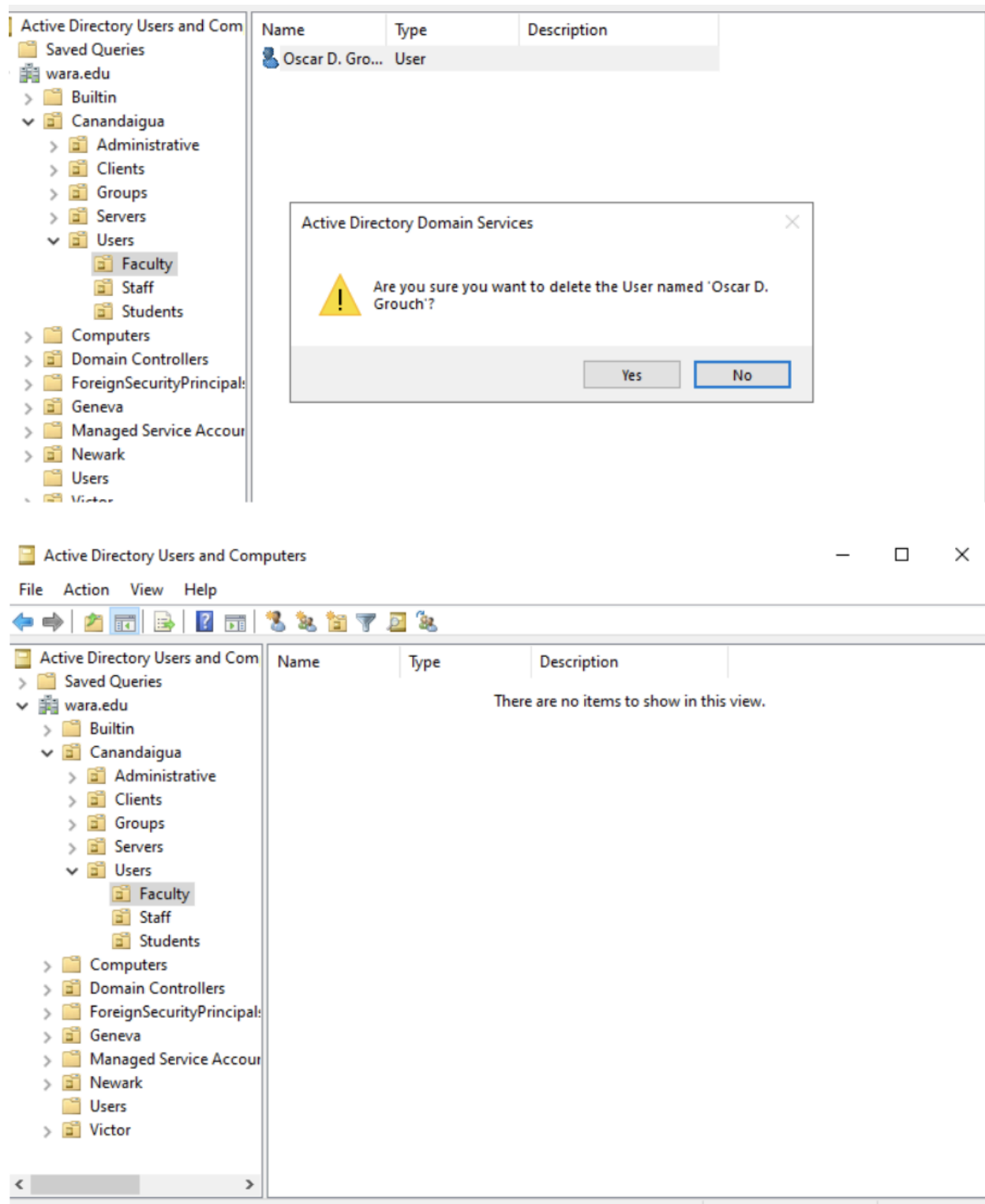


Figure 8: User account moved, renamed, or deleted as part of account lifecycle management.

Step 9: Searched and Filtered Active Directory Objects

Finally, I practiced searching and filtering Active Directory objects.

I used **Filter Options** to show only specific object types, such as computers. I also used the **Find** dialog box to search for users, contacts, groups, computers, and OUs.

This is helpful in real IT support because support analysts often need to quickly locate users, computers, or groups in Active Directory.

The lab shows how to use Filter Options and the Find dialog box to locate different Active Directory objects.

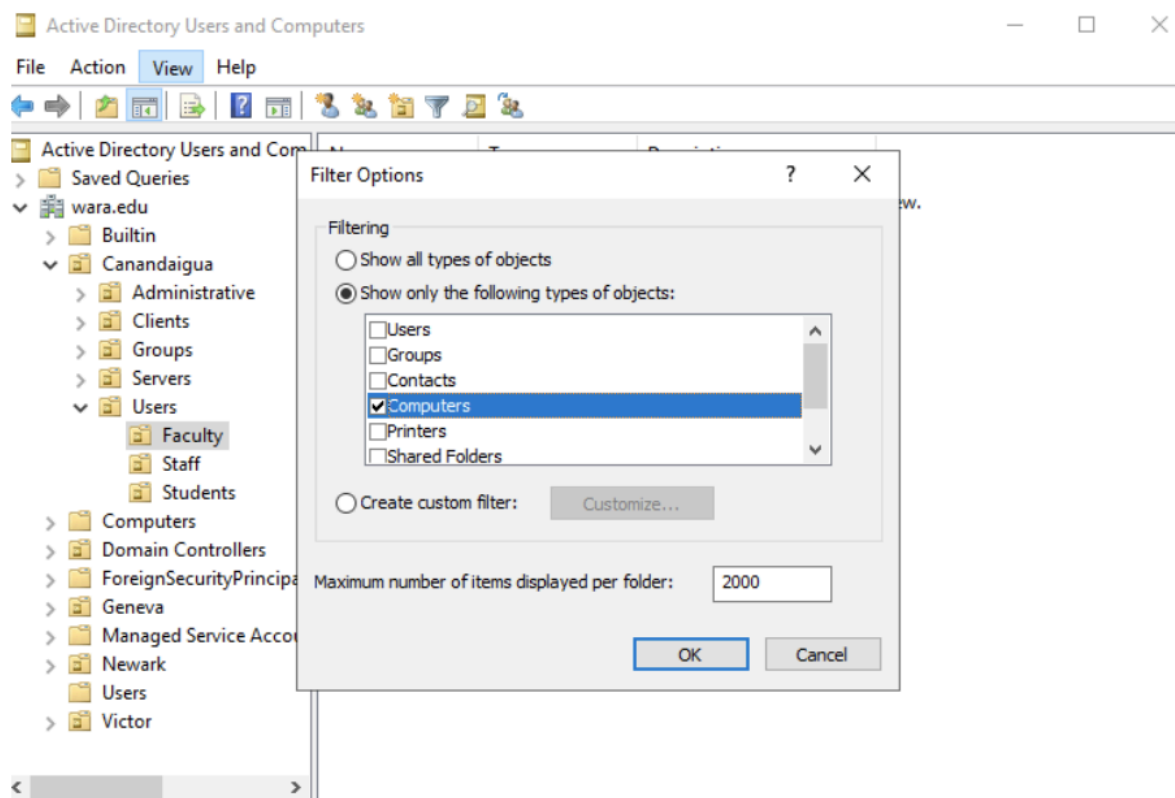


Figure 9: Active Directory search and filtering used to locate users, groups, and computer objects.

7. Key Findings

Finding	Explanation
---------	-------------

User accounts can be centrally managed	Active Directory allows IT teams to create, update, disable, and delete users from one location.
Group membership controls access	Adding users to groups affects their permissions and privileges.
Password reset is a key IT support task	Help desk teams commonly reset passwords and require password changes at next logon.
Disabled accounts cannot sign in	Disabling accounts helps protect systems when access should be removed.
User properties support organization	AD user properties store important contact and employee information.
Searching AD improves support efficiency	Filters and Find tools help locate users, computers, and groups quickly.

8. Analysis

This lab showed how Active Directory is used to manage the full user account lifecycle. In a real organization, IT teams create accounts for new employees, assign group membership, update user information, reset passwords, disable accounts when needed, and remove or archive old accounts.

One of the most important parts of this lab was understanding the difference between administrative and non-administrative users. Group membership can give users more access, so it must be managed carefully.

This lab also showed why disabling an account is often safer than deleting it immediately. Disabled accounts can preserve records while still preventing login access.

9. IT Support Relevance

This lab is highly relevant to IT Support Analyst, Help Desk Analyst, Desktop Support, and Junior System Administrator roles.

It connects to real job tasks such as:

- Creating new user accounts
- Resetting user passwords
- Unlocking or disabling accounts
- Updating user information

- Adding users to groups
- Verifying domain login
- Troubleshooting access issues
- Finding users and computers in Active Directory
- Supporting onboarding and offboarding
- Documenting account changes

10. Skills Demonstrated

This lab demonstrates:

- Active Directory user account creation
- User property management
- Group membership management
- Domain user sign-in testing
- Password reset workflow
- User must change password at next logon
- Account disable/enable testing
- User account movement between OUs
- User renaming and deletion
- Active Directory search and filtering
- PowerShell `whoami` verification
- IT support documentation

11. Ticket-Style Summary

Issue:

The domain environment needed user accounts created, assigned, tested, updated, and managed through Active Directory.

Impact:

Without proper account management, users would not be able to access domain resources securely or efficiently.

Steps Taken:

- Created a new staff user account.
- Created a non-admin user account.
- Added users to appropriate groups.
- Updated user account properties.
- Signed in to the Windows 10 client using a domain user.
- Verified the logged-in account using `whoami`.
- Reset the non-admin user's password.

- Required password change at next logon.
- Disabled and enabled the user account.
- Moved user accounts between OUs.
- Renamed and deleted test accounts.
- Used search and filter tools to locate Active Directory objects.

Root Cause:

User accounts and access settings needed to be created and managed in Active Directory.

Resolution:

Created and managed user accounts, configured group membership, tested domain login, reset passwords, disabled/enabled accounts, and verified account management tasks.

Status:

Completed successfully.

12. Lessons Learned

In this lab, I learned that user account management is one of the most important responsibilities in IT support. Active Directory allows IT teams to manage users, passwords, groups, and account access from one central location.

I also learned that group membership must be handled carefully because it controls access and privilege levels. Password resets, account disablement, and user searches are everyday help desk tasks, so practicing them in a lab helped me understand how these tasks work in real environments.